

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 1 – EMPLOYEE MANUAL

Policy: 202.12 Information Systems: Electronic Communication and Internet Usage Policy

11/2023

techniques while away from their computer. Any use that occurs on an employee's workstation under that employee's login is presumed to be performed by that employee. Log off the computer when you're not using it.

PROHIBITED USES OF CITY INFORMATION SYSTEMS

Prohibited uses of City information systems include, but are not limited to the following:

- Using City information systems for personal or pecuniary gain or solicitation, including but expressly not limited to, for or in connection with the establishment or conduct of outside employment, online gambling, personal businesses, or any other private or profit-making activity.
- Transmitting pictures, information, comments or other text that is insulting, offensive, disrespectful, discriminatory, demeaning, defamatory, pornographic, obscene, sexually suggestive or sexually explicit.
- Using City information systems in any manner that violates the City's or Department's policies against discrimination, harassment or retaliation based on sex or gender, pregnancy, childbirth (or related medical conditions), race, color, religion, national origin, ethnicity, ancestry, age, physical disability, mental disability, medical condition, marital status, sexual orientation, family care or medical leave status, military status, veteran status, or any other status protected by state and federal laws.
- Threats of violence or abusive conduct, sexual or ethnic slurs, obscenities, or any representation of obscenities.
- Transmitting, receiving, creating or storing jokes, junk mail, chain letters and other non-work-related items.
- Any personal use that interrupts City business and that keeps an employee from performing his/her work.
- Use by any member of his/her City e-mail account as their personal e-mail address or for personal e-mail messages.
- Extensive personal use of any City information system, the Internet or the Intranet, for any non-work-related purposes during working hours, which decreases employee productivity or results in decreased performance of the City's e-mail system.
- Unauthorized downloading and distributing of copyrighted materials (e.g. music, pictures or other proprietary information).
- Downloading or copying music, including music obtained legally, for non-business purposes, onto City computers or servers.
- Unauthorized reading, deleting, copying, modifying, or printing of electronic communication of another user.
- Instant messaging through public service providers. (e.g. AOL, Yahoo, MSN, etc.).
- Personal software, which allows peer-to-peer communications between two or more workstations. (e.g. online chat, KaZaA file sharing, etc.).

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- Personal access to any type of social media, including but not limited to Facebook, Snapchat, Twitter, chat rooms, blogs, etc., except for City-run Web pages and blogs.
- Personal use of the City's information systems for auctions such as eBay.
- Soliciting for political, religious or other non-business uses.
- Non-business related streaming media (e.g. listening to internet radio stations).
- Using City computers for any political purpose, including voting. This does not include using equipment designated for public voting at City Facilities.
- Sending or forwarding junk e-mail, chain letters, or mass mailings.
- Theft and /or forgery (or attempts) of messages or electronic documents.
- Using, accessing, or transmitting pornographic or sexually explicit materials, offensive threatening, harassing, discriminatory, racial, or hate language or images or writings.
- Engaging in any form of unlawful discrimination, harassment, or retaliation, whether sexual or otherwise, or sending any unwelcome personal communication. It is the perception of the recipient that prevails, not the intention of the sender.
- Allowing any unauthorized member, employee or third party to use or access the City's information systems, or any information, document or other writing maintained thereon.
- Attempting to circumvent security or data protection policies.
- Any unlawful or illegal purpose.
- Any use related to planning, promoting, or participating in personal activities, hobbies or private events.

Violation of this Policy may result in loss or restriction of a user's privileges or access to the City's information systems at any time without prior notice. In addition, any user who violates this Policy may be subject to disciplinary or legal action up to and including termination and/or criminal or civil penalties or other legal action.

PRIVACY AND MONITORING

The City of Calimesa and the Fire Department respect the individual privacy of its employees and members. However, the privacy rights of any Department member do not extend to (a) any work-related communications, (b) the use of City or Department information systems, or (c) to emails, records and other City or Department writings relating to City or Department business transmitted, received, created, or maintained using any City information system, or to any such City writings related to City or Department business using non-City issued email accounts or other non-City or non-Department information systems.

- Department members have no reasonable expectation of privacy in communications transmitted, received, stored or maintained over any Department or City-owned information systems, such communications are not confidential, notwithstanding any password or login credentials.

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- The City and Department has the right to access and monitor all City information systems, including all information, documents and other writings transmitted, received, created or stored using any City information systems, without notification.
- By using the City's information systems, each user acknowledges that the City may monitor all such uses and systems. By using the City's information systems, the user specifically consents to the City performing the monitoring function.

Only Department Heads or higher may request access and monitoring of City electronic communication of employees or other electronic communication users under their supervision.

RETENTION AND STORAGE

Electronic mail, data and postings received or transmitted using any City information system shall comply with any applicable provisions of the California Public Records Act . In addition, destruction of electronic records may be subject to the City's Records Retention Policy. E-mail in the trash basket falls under the one-month retention policy. Employees must not empty their electronic mail trash and must ensure that electronic systems are set appropriately to preserve messages for at least 30 days or such longer or shorter time as required by the City's records retention schedule.

USE OF PERSONAL INFORMATION SYSTEMS AND DEVICES

Department members should not receive or send Department records on a personal email account or other personal information systems, such as a personal smartphone or smartphone belonging to an outside employer or other non-Department issued device, as such communication may be a public record subject to disclosure under the California Public Records Act.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RECEIPT

Each member of the Department shall, prior to commencement of work or services, shall sign an Acknowledgment of Receipt of this Policy and the City-wide Information Systems.

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Policy: 202.13 Cell Phones

11/2023

PURPOSE

The purpose of the Cell Phone Policy is to ensure that all Fire Department personnel have a complete understanding of the rules. Use of personal cell phones at work is a privilege, not a right.

POLICY

Personal cell phones shall not be used by a member while working on any incident. This prohibition includes texting, or Social Media Platforms including but not limited to Instagram, Twitter, and any other communications that the employee or other member may have on their cell phone.

Personal cell phones shall not be used to take any pictures or record any events of any incident to which staff may be assigned.

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Policy: 203.01 Personal Appearance and Dress Code

11/2018

PURPOSE

The purpose of the Personal Appearance and Dress Code Policy is to establish a structure for the Calimesa Fire Department's staff to utilize when preparing themselves for on-duty appearance or representation of the Fire Department.

POLICY

It shall be the responsibility of all members of the Calimesa Fire Department to adhere to the standards of the Department's Personal Appearance and Dress Code Policy set forth herein standards.

Supervisors and managers shall review their subordinates' appearance to ensure that all members conform to the Personal Appearance and Dress Code Policy.

On-duty personnel shall maintain a neat, clean, and professional appearance. Employees and all other Department members are expected to be well groomed, without excessive ornamentation and dressed in Department uniform or business attire.

Employees who are authorized to wear their uniform while working an off-duty assignment shall comply with the same standards as those for on-duty personnel.

Personnel requesting a deviation from the policy shall submit a written communication to the Fire Chief or Deputy Fire Chief that includes an explanation and justification for the need to stray from compliance with the protocol. Executive management shall review the request and determine if the deviation will be consistent with the Fire Department's professional culture.

Uniforms shall be kept in a clean and serviceable condition. Uniforms shall be ready at all times for immediate use.

All employees shall maintain their hair in a neat, clean, and well-groomed manner to reflect the professional and businesslike appearance of the Fire Department. Unacceptable hair styles include, but are not limited to, design(s) sculpted into the hair or wearing long hair over a shaved (to scalp) portion of the head. Hair dyeing or highlighting is acceptable provided it is consistent with a natural hair color without distinct blocks, patterns or spots of color. Color tints and over-dyes are not acceptable.

Employees are permitted to wear wigs or hairpieces for hair disorders. The wig or hairpiece must conform to the Department's hair standard.

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MALE PERSONNEL

Male employees shall maintain their hair properly trimmed and at least moderately tapered. The hair shall not extend below the top of the shirt collar, cover any portion of the ear, and shall not interfere with the employee's vision. Male employees shall ensure that their hair does not interfere with the proper wearing of a uniform hat or the ability to promptly and correctly put on the protective head, face, or respiratory gear.

Male employees shall not have sideburns that extend beyond a point even with the bottom of the ear lobe and shall extend in a clean-shaven horizontal line. The flare (terminal portion of the sideburn) shall not exceed the width of the the sideburn. Sideburns shall be trimmed and neat in appearance.

Male personnel shall not wear decorative hair ornamentation while in uniform.

Male employees shall maintain a freshly shaven facial appearance on a daily basis while on duty.

Male employees are permitted to elect to wear a short and neatly trimmed mustache of natural color. Mustaches shall not interfere with the wearing and function of Respirators or Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus mask as required by the Respiratory Protection policy.

Male employees shall not wear facial beards styles while in uniform.

Male Employees' fingernails shall be neat, clean, and properly trimmed. Fingernails shall not display decals or ornamentation. Fingernails shall not extend more than one-fourth inch beyond the tip of the finger. They shall not interfere with the employee's duty performance.

Male employees on duty in uniform or businesslike attire are authorized to wear:

- One conservative ring on each hand (engagement and wedding ring when worn on the same finger count as one ring)
- Conventional wristwatch, religious ornament worn underneath the uniform.
- Police/ Firefighter/ Military Killed In The Line Of Duty remembrance bracelet
- Medical alert necklace may be worn underneath the uniform or worn as a bracelet.

On-duty male employees shall not wear any other type of visible body ornamentation such as, but not limited to, multiple earrings in each ear, nose studs, nose or eyebrow rings, tongue studs or rings, or lip studs or rings.

On-duty male employees shall comply with the City of Calimesa tattoo Policy. When required employees shall cover all tattoo(s)/branding(s) by wearing an authorized long-sleeved uniform

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shirt or pants if in uniform. If in business attire, the business attire shall cover all tattoos and brandings.

FEMALE PERSONNEL

Female employees shall arrange their hair, so it does not extend below the bottom edge of the shirt collar. The hair shall be arranged not to interfere with the employee's vision. Also, the hair arrangement shall not cause safety concerns when working near equipment or live fire settings. Female employees shall ensure that their hair does not interfere with the proper wearing of a uniform hat or the ability to promptly and correctly put on the protective head, face or respiratory gear.

Female employees in uniform may utilize hair control devices. The hair control devices shall be inconspicuous such as cloth-covered rubber bands (not to exceed one-quarter inch in diameter), plain hairpins, or clips. The hair control devices shall either be black or consistent with the employee's hair color and shall in no way detract from an employee's uniform appearance. The hair control devices shall not interfere with the proper wearing of a uniform hat or the ability to promptly and correctly put on the protective head, face or respiratory gear.

Female employees shall not wear decorative hair ornamentation while in uniform.

Female employees in work assignments where business attire is permitted, may elect to wear businesslike hair ornamentation.

Female employees' fingernails shall be neat, clean, and properly trimmed. Fingernails shall not display decorations. Fingernails shall not extend more than one-fourth inch beyond the tip of the finger. They shall not interfere with the employee's duty performance.

Female employees are authorized to wear a single matched pair of earrings, one earring on each earlobe. The earrings shall be conservative, professional, and businesslike in appearance.

Female employees on duty in uniform or business attire are authorized to wear:

- One conservative ring on each hand (engagement and wedding ring when worn on the same finger count as one ring)
- Conventional wristwatch, religious ornament worn underneath the uniform.
- Police/ Firefighter/ Military Killed in The Line Of Duty remembrance bracelet
- Medical alert necklace may be worn underneath the uniform or worn as a bracelet.

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On-duty female employees shall not wear any other type of visible body ornamentation such as, but not limited to, multiple earrings in each ear, nose studs, nose or eyebrow rings, tongue studs or rings, or lip studs or rings.

On-duty female employees shall comply with the City of Calimesa tattoo policy. When required employees shall cover all tattoos and brandings by wearing an authorized long-sleeved uniform shirt or pants if in uniform. If in business attire, the business attire shall hide all tattoos and brandings.

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Policy: 203.02 Uniform Committee

11/2018

PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to establish a Fire Department policy pertaining to the role of the Uniform Committee.

The Uniform Committee shall act as an advisory group to the Fire Chief. The role of the Committee is to provide user input in an effort to keep uniforms safe, functional, and stylish.

To ensure that the Department uniform remains standard and easily recognizable, the number of uniform variations or "options" shall be regulated by the Fire Chief.

The wearing of clothing items other than those identified in 100.03 shall be on approval of the Fire Chief and will normally be for the sole purpose of evaluation.

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Policy: 203.03 Uniforms and Insignias

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the uniform and insignias policy is to establish a standard for the Department personnel to refer to when wearing a Calimesa Fire Department Uniform.

UNIFORMS

All members of the Calimesa Fire Department when on duty, as noted below, shall wear the appropriate uniform. All Fire Department members are responsible for obtaining and maintaining the uniform items required for their assignment. All uniform items shall be maintained in presentable condition. Faded, worn or damaged clothing is not acceptable; this includes faded lettering or markings on uniform items requiring such markings.

All uniform shirts shall be presented with a Department approved American flag patch sewn on the left shoulder region and a Calimesa Fire Department patch sewn on the right shoulder region. A nameplate consisting of the employee's last name shall be displayed above the right shirt pocket.

Civilian clothes are optional for members assigned to staff and special assignments as authorized by the Fire Chief.

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

All members of the Calimesa Fire Department, while engaged in public contact duties, shall wear the same type of uniform at the same time (i.e., all members wearing the regulation dress shirt and appropriate trousers, not just the company officer). Company Officers will ensure that all members are appropriately dressed for the specific activity.

Personnel appearing for a trial or hearing representing the Calimesa Fire Department shall wear the dress uniform.

Personnel attending funerals or assigned to funeral detail shall wear the dress uniform with a navy-blue necktie and badge shroud. Pallbearers may wear white gloves.

The wearing of miniature replica pins such as those given with the Medal of Valor, Medal of Honor or other awards of Merit or City of Calimesa Service Pins SHALL follow the guidelines specified by the Fire Chief.